Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Newsletter: Second Month, 2026

Monthly Query: *How am I following Jesus' example of love in action?*

Monthly Worship Tip from the M&W Committee: *Is the hour of meeting for worship the only time in the week you seek to nourish your spiritual life?*

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Monthly Calendar

First Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** • 9:30 - 10:30 am - **Forum via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Worship in the meeting room** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Online worship via Zoom** • After meeting - **Potluck in the schoolhouse**
Second Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** • 9:30 - 10:30 am - **Forum via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Blended Meeting in the meeting room and via Zoom**
Third Sunday	• 8:00 - 9:00 am - **Early worship in the meeting room** (reverts to 8:15 the following week) • 9:00 - 10:30 am - **Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business via Zoom** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Worship in the meeting room** • 11:00 am - 12:00 - **Online worship via Zoom**
Fourth Sunday	• Same as Second Sunday - **Blended Meeting**
Fifth Sunday	• Same as First Sunday, but without potluck

Upcoming Zoom Fora

https://www.chapelhillfriends.org/forums.html

February 1: **Quakers Discern Genocide is Occurring in Gaza and Urge Courageous Action. Where does CHFM Stand?** In July of 2025, eight national and international-level Quaker organizations discerned that genocide was occurring in Gaza and urged courageous action in response. Friends Meetings were invited to discuss, discern, and endorse the statement. In this Forum, the Peace and Justice Committee, together with our Quaker-inspired Action for Gaza group will begin this process. We will read the statement together, hear briefly from Quaker, Jewish, and Muslim individuals with a concern for this issue, and begin a discussion which may eventually move to Meeting for Business. Please join us.

February 8: **The 4 Roles of Social Change**. Helper, organizer, advocate, and rebel. Which one draws you in? Which is most challenging? Which is missing in your community? Led by Walter Hjelt-Sullivan.

February 15: Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business (no forum)

February 22: **Cybersecurity and Internet Scams**. Join us for an educational presentation about keeping yourself and our community safe from online emotional and financial harm. Lovingly presented by Calaway Rohloff.

Upcoming Events

Christian Nationalism: Learn More, Jan.25 - Feb.15

Dottie Heninger shares with Friends:

Wes Wallace, MD, a friend from the Clergy Coalition, sent this invitation. University United Methodist Church is providing this important course for faith communities in Orange County.

He writes: The seminars will be on serial Sundays, each will last an hour and will focus on understanding the dangerous ideology of Christian Nationalism and the risk it poses to faith, freedom of religion and democracy.

Taught by Dr. Lester Ruth of Duke Seminary and Dr. Joey Shelton, pastor, attorney and educator, each hour-long seminar will begin at **9:15 am**. The sessions will begin **January 25** and continue each Sunday **through February 15**--a total of four sessions.
Both speakers have national expertise regarding Christian Nationalism and bring presenting skills and clarity to this important problem.

I realize that Sunday at 9:15 a.m. might well conflict with events in your faith community. The pastors at UUMC feel that this issue is important enough to ask all of our adult Sunday school classes to cancel their usual plans and join these seminars. I hope that you and your congregants can find a way to join us. For now, please save the dates for Sundays from January 25 through February 15. More details soon.

Thank you and I hope Friends at the Quaker Meeting can join us.
Best,
Wes Wallace, MD

Gaza: Past, Present and Future, Sun. Feb 1, 1:00 pm

Walter Sullivan shares with Friends:

Gaza: Past, Present and Future: Sunday, February 1st at 1:00 pm. AFSC's Jennifer Bing, director of the AFSC Gaza program, and Zoe Jannuzzi who works closely with Jennifer, will present to us about Gaza, Palestine and Israel: past - present - and, especially, future. The Peace and Social Concerns Committee of Central Philadelphia Friends Meeting will host Jennifer via Zoom and Zoe will join us in person in the Rufus Jones Room at the Friends Center. The event will be hybrid, using this link. https://bit.ly/FriendsWorship. All are welcome.

Symposium on Reproductive Health, Sat. Feb 7

Your Interfaith Voices for Reproductive Health representatives share with Friends:

Free half-day symposium on **Saturday February 7th in Chapel Hill**
NC's Reproductive Healthcare Crisis: Misinformation, Misdirected Funding
A nonpartisan event to examine NC's reproductive healthcare system and the growing role of Crisis Pregnancy Centers (CPCs). Our confirmed speakers include Dr. Amy Bryant (UNC-CH), Tara Romano Pro-Choice NC, and Emma Horst-Martz Planned Parenthood Votes! South Atlantic. Click below for the full info sheet:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/19Cz25ywyBx0SYZuDdfcjzhEH6Q8kkeQt/edit?usp=sharing&ouid=101327796055197218998&rtpof=true&sd=true for the full info sheet

Preregistration is required. (Register by Sunday February 1st.) Venue location will be shared after registration.

Piedmont Friends Retreat & Annual Sessions, June 5, 6, 7

Piedmont Friends will be meeting for the 2026 Retreat & Annual Sessions at Haw River State Park, June 5, 6, 7.

As we prepare for this expanded gathering, we are inviting all Piedmont Friends meetings to participate in the planning and to recommend a Friend from their meeting to serve on the Retreat Planning Committee.

The Committee will meet periodically on Zoom to plan for

- Retreat theme, focus and queries
- Adult, Youth and Young Adult Programming
- Accommodations and meal arrangements with Haw River State Park
- Coordinate with the Clerking Committee the Annual Sessions
- Retreat flyer, communications, registration

Information about the Retreat and Haw River State Park, including some pictures from an initial site-visit, is available on our website at:
https://www.piedmontfriends.org/2026-retreat-annual-sessions/

Announcements

Bequests to the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

The Finance committee wants to remind everyone of the importance of including our Meeting in your estate plans.

Bequests to CHFM enhance the life of our Meeting and they serve to ensure its long term financial security.

We encourage you to read the Finance Committee's complete estate planning guide!

AFSC's Response to De-Registration in Gaza

Whitney Fry shares with Friends:

Despite the recent regulations by the Israeli government that has resulted in de-registration of international NGOs (including AFSC), AFSC is able to continue its work through local staff and partners, as well as its registration in the Palestinian Territory. From the beginning of its operations in Gaza, AFSC served as a distribution partner, working primarily with local staff and partners This localized model allows the organization to continue working. It will not be able to bring in international staff or aid from across borders, but it will continue to work in Gaza as a local entity. For more information, click here.

AFSC's New Initiative to Encourage Quaker Engagement

Whitney Fry shares with Friends:

Love As Action: AFSC's New Initiative to Encourage Quaker (and others!) Engagement. In response to the crisis in our nation, AFSC has begun a new initiative called Love As Action: Silent worship vigils in public spaces across the country. This is an opportunity for Quakers and others to bear witness—silently and in a spirit of workshop—to rising oppression in the US. See here for more information. Anyone (and any meeting) can organize a vigil or join one that's already organized. AFSC has listed for ways to organize/host, sign up to attend an already organized event, and download resources.

CFS Beloved Community Offerings this Coming Spring

Pam Schwingl shares with Friends:
From Carolina Friends School Beloved Community Institute:

UPCOMING WELLNESS AND TRANSFORMATIONAL TRAVEL-LEARNING PROGRAMS
Registration opens soon!

- **Coastal Journey**, a six-day racial justice trip to Savannah and Charleston. **Early March 2026**
- **Quaker Journey**, a weeklong visit to the 17th-century roots of Quakerism in the breathtaking Lake District of Northern England. **2-9 August 2026**

You can see links for these and additional offerings at www.cfsnc.org/AdultEnrichment.

Personals

A New Home for Little Bear

Annalee Harkins shares with Friends:

I am seeking a foster or potential re-homing for my dog, Little Bear, whom I adopted 6 months ago. Little Bear is 3 years old, 27 lbs, and a perfect angel - but unfortunately, my pre-existing dog, who is old and blind, wants to murder him.

More information and pictures of Little Bear are available here:
https://forms.gle/Ycw25acCNM3NqmLb7

Please feel free to reach out to me directly (text is best, 919-370-2054) and share widely!

With gratitude,
Annalee
919-370-2054

Recurring Announcements

InterFath Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers

We invite anyone interested in becoming, or knowing more about being an IFC Committee Member to please contact Carolyn White.

We welcome volunteers to help with food preparation and service at ICF every second Thursday for lunch: 10a - 1p, and/or every second Friday for dinner 4p-6:30p. Volunteers are welcome for part of the shift, or the full shift.

Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted

Support Chapel Hill Friends Meeting's Zoom worship and forums by becoming a tech host. The role is much more simple than you would imagine. Trust us! We need your help and will train you. Please contact the Zoom Subcommittee if interested, or have questions: zoom@chapelhillfriends.org.

Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items

Please consider IFC's needs when doing your shopping. There is a basket in the meetinghouse foyer for food donations. IFC has requested the following food items: coffee, hot chocolate, canned protein, canned pork and beans, canned soup (not vegetable), boxed cereal, cake mixes, instant foods, ramen noodles. Thank you!

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.

The CFS Early School teachers, parents and guests have priority use of the meetinghouse parking lot from 7:30 AM to 6:00 PM Monday through Friday throughout the calendar year. If you must visit the meetinghouse during weekday hours, please alert John Hite, the Meetinghouse Resident, at least one day ahead. Email: johnthequaker@gmail.com or call: 919-929-5377.

Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Please send items for the weekly eNews email and the monthly print Newsletter to news@chapelhillfriends.org.

- The deadline for weekly eNews is *Wednesday* 5 pm.
- The deadline for the monthly print Newsletter is on the *last day of the month*.

To unsubscribe, email to news@chapelhillfriends.org with the subject line, Unsubscribe.

Note: If you think that you haven't received your weekly enews or monthly newsletter, it helps to add news@chapelhillfriends.org to your contacts. Otherwise it might go to your Spam folder (and likewise for other chapelhillfriends.org mailing lists such as pfym@chapelhillfriends.org).

Recurring Events

Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm

YOU ARE INVITED TO PARTICIPATE IN Virtual Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the 2nd and 4th Wednesday of each month, 7:00 to 8:30 PM. Join us when you can for as long as you wish - from your own home.

Do you have a name or a group of people to add to - or remove from - the list of those we will hold in our hearts and prayers? If so, please send to: prayers@chapelhillfriends.org. The list of names to be held in the Light will be renewed each month. Names must be resubmitted each month to be maintained on the list. We'll send an updated list on Wednesday afternoons. Thank you for joining us!

This virtual prayer service continues under the care of the Care and Counsel Committee and each week, a committee member will collect and post the names that are submitted and will read them aloud during the time of the service.

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine. Thursdays, 5:30pm

You are invited to join Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine and Israel at 5:30 p.m. ET / 2:30 p.m. PT.

Join on Zoom:
https://afsc-org.zoom.us/j/85831333364?pwd=VEtPTUZuYk5hTHV2OGs1VzRkY0ZKUT09
Meeting ID: 858 3133 3364
Passcode: 759311

Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am

Pendle Hill Quaker Study, Retreat, and Conference Center is now opening their daily morning worship to everyone, by way of Zoom or phone. A lovely opportunity for gathered worship every morning. “A handful of Pendle Hill residents continue to gather daily in the Barn – from 8:30am to 9:10am Eastern Time – expanding the 90-year-long tradition of daily worship here on campus. Beginning the week of March 16, 2020, we started an experiment of opening the circle of worship to YOU in your home. You can join us here via Zoom.”
https://pendlehill.org/explore/worship/join-us-online-for-worship-in-the-barn/?bblinkid=210290749&bbemailid=19903873&bbejrid=1408822779

Note: The above link takes you *not* to the meeting but to a page of general instructions. Look for the sentence “You can join us via Zoom **here**, or by clicking on the image below.”

Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Link to the Daily Meeting for Worship for Peace sponsored by FHM/FHMSA: (Friends House Moscow)
Join Zoom Meeting
https://us02web.zoom.us/j/4165005614?pwd=NUtieEtqbDBYbjBrcGdMMzBKQ3drQT09
Meeting ID: 416 500 5614
Passcode: 182805

The room opens at 8:45am Pacific time (10:45 EST); worship begins on the hour and ends an hour later. After worship there will be time to share brief thoughts that did not rise to the level of ministry. You may also want to rename yourself indicating your geographic location. There will be no audible indicator when one enters or leaves, and everyone will be muted on entry. Please leave yourself muted unless giving ministry.

Ministry may also be shared in the chat, but it is not the place for private conversations. If you are new to Quaker unprogrammed worship and wish to talk with someone about it, send a message to the host and someone can join you in a breakout room.

Business Meeting Minutes

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Minutes for Worship with Attention to Business, January 18, 2026 via Zoom

Attendance: Jeff Brown, Jennifer Leeman, Hank Elkins, Betsy Brinson, David Waterman, Tony Hickey, Quaker Harmon, John Pilgrim, Astra Titus, Jan Hutton, Jessica Eustice, Carolyn White, Carolyn Stuart, John Hite, Susan Newcomer, Deborah Gibbs, Allie Scales, Matt and Lynn Drake, Tom Ludlow, Dottie Heninger, Ben Ousley, Naveed Moeed, Marion Schoenbach, Julia Cleaver, Wendy Michener, Ann Miller, Tori Toles, Colleen Fay, Tom Munk, Nancy Milio, Walter Hvelt Sullivan, Melissa Ruof, Herb Derbie, Susan Peterson, Paul Munk, Emilie Condon, Curt Torell, Buzz Borchardt

1. We opened with worship and the query, "How am I open to new Light, from whatever source it may come?"
2. We welcomed Melissa Ruof as a first-time attender of Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business.
3. Friends approved the minutes of the December 2025 Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business as written.
4. Carolyn Stuart and Ann Miller, members of the newly appointed Naming Committee, recommended two individuals to serve on Nomination Committee: Betsy Brinson and Buzz Borchardt. Friends approved this recommendation.
5. Naveed Moeed, co-clerk of the Buildings and Grounds Committee, presented the committee's annual report (Appendix A). Naveed noted appreciation for those in the community who have contributed to the committee's work. Friends were encouraged to consider whether they feel led to join Buildings and Grounds Committee, which would benefit from additional members. Friends accepted the report with gratitude for the work of the committee.
6. Alice Carlton, clerk of Care & Council Committee, presented the committee's annual report (Appendix B). Friends noted their appreciation for committee's attention to diverse individual needs and the organizations of small groups for fellowship. Friends accepted the report with gratitude for the work of the committee.
7. Jan Hutton, clerk of Shotts Memorial/Leadership Development Fund Committee, presented the committee's Annual Report (Appendix C). In response to a Friend's question, Jan clarified that funds may be available for leadership activities organized by Friends in addition to individual requests for funds to attend leadership development opportunities. Several upcoming opportunities were noted, including programs offered by Carolina Friends School, the pilgrimage

to England, and Piedmont Friends Yearly Meeting & Fellowship. Friends accepted the report with gratitude for the work of the committee.

8. Jeff Brown, Clerk, presented a proposal to create an ad hoc committee to recommend hiring a Zoom technical host (Appendix D). A Friend requested that we consider the impact this would have on the Meeting budget. With budget in mind, Friends supported the importance of exploring additional support for technical hosting. Friends approved the proposal. Jeff asked that Ministry and Worship, Finance, and the Zoom subcommittee recommend volunteers and that others volunteer who feel so led. Astra Titus volunteered to serve.

9. The next Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business is planned for 9:00 AM on February 15, 2026.

10. Announcements:

    The Ministry & Worship Committee is holding a retreat on Saturday, February 21. The theme will be "Native American Communities and Quakers and Quakerism in North Carolina." Our goal will be to understand more about the history and present vitality of Native American tribal groups in our state. We'll also discuss how our meeting might do more to support the aspirations and goals of these communities. The morning session will focus on themes in Kathleen DuVal's book *Native Nations: A Millenium in North America* and a conversation with her. Lunch will be served. The afternoon session will focus on the cultural identities, activities and shared objectives of Native American groups in our region.

11. We closed with silent worship.

    Jeff Brown, Clerk, and Jennifer Leeman, Recording Clerk

Appendix A: Buildings & Grounds Annual Report 2024-2025

The Building and Grounds Committee (B&G) oversees the condition and maintenance of the meetinghouse and the grounds. Most of this work is done by committee members. When there is need for professional work or larger projects, B&G assesses the situation and makes recommendations to Meeting for Business. B&G oversees and works closely with the resident. With the help of the resident, B&G oversees the use of the meetinghouse and the schoolhouse.

Resident

John Hite, as the meeting house resident, continued providing care and security for the meeting house, the meeting grounds, and the Chapel Hill Friends Early School (CHES) throughout this reporting period. He supported the work of the Building and Grounds, the Library committee, First Day School Upper Pod, and since the pandemic has worked closely with and supported the Zoom ad hoc committee to enable hybrid Meeting for Worship. John liaises closely with Ministry and Worship and the Hospitality committees. John served as our daily liaison with CHES, assisting with a few school building issues which occurred outside of school hours. John once again organized and managed parking for UNC home football games, bringing in significant monetary resources to our beloved community. For the period covered by this report (June 2024-December 2025), this brought in $20,765 from 12 Football Games and 2 International Soccer Matches. In addition to his regular resident duties, John made substantial contributions to volunteer labor on major projects, including significant time spent clearing branches and debris following Hurricane Helene in September 2024. In addition, John spent significant person-hours single-handedly continuing the removal of invasive species at the back of our property. It is estimated he has contributed over 100 person-hours in this regard.

Committee Membership

- Current Committee Members: Caroline Carmen (representing CHES/CFS), John Hite (co-clerk), Naveed Moeed (co-clerk), Peter Malone, Ken Bassinger, Cecilia King, Richard Miller, Jessica Eustice, Eric Feickert
- Membership Changes: Wendy Michener, longtime committee member, rotated off the committee at the end of June 2025. We minuted with gratitude her many years of dedicated service. We welcomed new members Eric Feickert and Jessica Eustice to the committee during this reporting period.

As a committee, we are very appreciative of the various strengths, skills, and backgrounds that each member brings to our shared work. This diversity of experience and perspective has been essential to our ability to address complex projects and ongoing maintenance needs.

Accomplished Tasks

- Please note that for the following indications of volunteer hours given are not sub-divided into time given by the resident, other members of Building and Grounds or other members/attenders of the Meeting. The majority of our work is done by the resident but on other projects (e.g. HVAC) significant volunteer time contribution is provided by members of Building and Grounds. In other areas the community comes together with many members and attenders of the Meeting volunteering hours on our Work Mornings. .

- Storm Damaged Tree Removal (September-October 2024)
    - On Friday, September 27, 2024, a significant White Pine tree fell. The tree had stood on the Southeast corner of the meetinghouse by the parking lot and porch, and it fell perilously close to the building and porch. We also had two nearby smallish Privet trees by the Memorial Garden affected by the storm. B&G engaged Treeist for the removal and stump grinding work. Preparation work was done by Building and Grounds members, and John Hite performed several hours of clearing branches and debris to make the Meetinghouse accessible before professional removal began. Caroline Carman coordinated the removal to align with the Chapel Hill Early School's schedule. The tree was removed on Tuesday, October 1st, and stump grinding was completed on Friday, October 11th. The students at CHES greatly enjoyed observing this process.
    - The tree removal revealed that one railing near the porch had been bent by the falling tree. This railing was subsequently stabilized and repaired through volunteer efforts led by Richard Miller and Eric Feickert, with special cement purchased and careful work to rebuild the sockets and secure the structure.
    - Volunteer Hours for Hurricane Recovery: Approximately 80 person-hours of volunteer labor by committee members and meeting attendees.
- Work Morning: Over the last 18 months, we have had 3+ work mornings with about 50 people in total come out for which we are appreciative.
    - This has been our committee's most significant undertaking during this reporting period.
- HVAC Ventilation System Major Project (Ongoing, July 2023 – Present)
    - This has been our committee's most significant undertaking during this reporting period. The HVAC project originated from a spirit-led initiative by the Ministry and Worship Committee, who in March 2021 requested that B&G evaluate mitigation measures for virus transmission in the meetinghouse. Over the following years, we conducted extensive research and planning.
    - In the prior reporting period (July 2023 – July 2024): Installation of energy recovery units relocated from beneath the early school to the attic.
    - (September 2024 – December 2025): Ongoing design work and implementation for the downstairs areas, which has proven more complex than initially anticipated. Peter Malone has led this work with exceptional dedication, giving significant volunteer time. As of December 2025, remaining work includes cross connections and final trunk lines.
    - Throughout this project, Peter has worked with SHRI's principal engineer and incorporated suggestions from the committee.
    - The committee has presented this major project to the Meeting through forums, recognizing the need for the community to process and understand the changes to the meeting room and building.

    - HVAC Project Volunteer Hours: Over 300 person-hours of volunteer labor by Peter Malone and others, with all design and planning work completed by volunteers.

- Chapel Hill Friends Early School (CHES) Site Improvements
    - Working closely with Mark Shanahan from CFS Caroline Carman (head of CHES), the committee addressed numerous capital projects at the schoolhouse during this reporting period:
    - Summer 2024 Improvements:
        - Water remediation plan with Shamrock Waterproofing (foundation drainage work: $5,000)
        - Foundation pier reinforcement work below the gathering room
        - New drain installation and replacement of existing drains
        - Sealing of cracks on sidewalk
        - New swing set installation
        - Fix of rotten post between swings and tire swings
        - De-humidifier check-in and recommendation for new vapor barrier
        - Radon testing (results well within safety margins)
        - Installation of emergency light and cable repair
        - Water cooler replacement
        - Compost Now partnership established with large compost bin installed
    - 2024-2025 Work:
        - Gutter replacement and fixing (ongoing foundation protection)
        - Multiple smaller repairs coordinated with professional contractors
        - Uneven concrete repairs completed by Concrete Uprising (April 14, 2025)
        - Installation of grates
        - Flooring replacement in classroom, hallways, and kitchen (scheduled for Winter Break 2025-2026)
        - Power washing of sidewalks
    - The committee had representation at meetings with CHES including Caroline Carman, John Hite, Karen Cumberbatch, Mark Shanahan, John Pilgrim, and Ann Miller to review maintenance obligations, significant expenditures, and records of previous upgrades (roof replacement, HVAC, appliances, etc.).

- Blocked sewage drain for CHES and Meetinghouse:
    - Backed up toilets in CHES led to the engagement of two plumbing forms and the eventual realization that there was a serious drainage issue underneath our parking lot at the junction of the drains from CHES and the Meetinghouse. A plumbing firm from Carrboro capable of taking on this work came out and discovered that the old piping had given way and would need to be replaced. A joint effort between CHES and B&G led to the eventual resolution of this issue with the aid of the plumbing company in question.

    - Estimated Volunteer Hours for CHES coordination: Significant time by Caroline Carman in coordinating contractors, timelines, and school operations.

- Ecological Landscaping and Grounds Beautification (2023 – December 2025)
    - This multi-year initiative to address invasive species and improve the grounds around both buildings has been a significant undertaking:
    - 2024-2025 Work:
        - Proposal development by Naveed Moeed for ecological landscape restoration, focusing on the area behind the schoolhouse
        - Planning for thick layer of wood chips to prevent regrowth
        - Design of fast-growing native pine trees (4-year growth timeline) to restore privacy barriers
        - Ecological Landscaping Company engaged again for intensive bamboo removal (~$3,800 for one-week work effort)
        - Removal of cuttings with volunteer manpower
        - Comprehensive clearing of back schoolhouse area with removal of several dumpster loads (~$800)
        - Peter Malone's herbicide spraying (Bullseye treatment) across cleared areas to prevent regrowth

- Chipdrop partnership established for delivery of wood chips (60 yards needed for ditch and other areas). We are currently negotiating with Chip drop management to deliver chips directly to ditch for erosion control and drainage benefit
- The committee continues to determine that substantial work remains to ensure that flora on our grounds are healthy and not being choked out by invasive vines or bamboo. This will be ongoing work. Significant bamboo removal began in mid-October 2025.
- Volunteer hours from John Hite and others continue to contribute to this effort. In this reporting period we estimate 160 volunteer hours

- Grounds and Building Routine Maintenance
    - Most regular maintenance is completed by John Hite on a set schedule. Work completed during this reporting period includes:
        - Bathroom drain repair (sink and toilet wax ring)
        - Cecelia has come by a number of times when chainsaw work and hauling has been needed.
        - Radon testing completed (Fall 2024): Results well within safety margins
        - Annual elevator inspection (November 2025): Found emergency light not functioning; no load testing currently required. The elevator used monthly to maintain active status. There is work ongoing to maintain the functionality of our elevator and be within inspection parameters.
        - Railing bent by fallen tree: Repair work by Eric Feickert and Jessie Eustice using special cement and socket rebuilding; now very secure

    - Basement tile curling (from cold snap): Ken Bassinger addressed with adhesive solutions
    - Mailbox replacement: Completed by Naveed Moeed (new mailbox installed; base wobbles slightly but is sturdy and rooted in concrete)
    - Power washing of meetinghouse: Back of building roof overhang has mildew requiring professional power washing (~$150 quote); Front sidewalk power washing (~$200 quote); Eric Feickert generously provided volunteer power washing services for the front.
    - European hornet problem: Encountered during HVAC work; extermination completed on 8/20/25 and again on 9/5/25 (cost: $600); Second visit coordinated by Richard Miller and Naveed Moeed. Future prevention including covering holes in attic to be addressed.

- Future work:
    - Tree of Heaven (Ailanthus altissima): This invasive species remains a priority for removal; Naveed has researched all available grants (federal grants currently unavailable); CC King taking first pass on local grant applications; the tree was vandalized with an ax to the side, requiring revised removal plan
    - Ongoing work on invasive species. Ecological Landscaping Continuation: Completion of bamboo removal, mulching, and establishment of native tree barrier on schoolhouse side
    - Mulching the back of the property
    - HVAC Ventilation Project Completion: Final phases of ductwork and system testing.
    - Facility Improvements: Power washing of roof overhangs; potential picnic table refinishing/replacement; potential shrubbery replacement on Raleigh Road with native species (pending sound/sight barrier solutions)

Lovingly submitted by B & G members: John Hite, Naveed Moeed, Peter Malone, Caroline Carman, Richard Miller, Eric Feickert, Cecelia King and Jessie Eustice

Appendix B: Care & Counsel Annual Report: Dec. 2024 - Dec. 2025

The Care & Counsel Committee, composed of members of the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting, is responsible for the pastoral care of the Meeting's members and attenders. Pastoral care can include a wide range: checking on Friends undergoing any number of medical procedures, visiting Friends in the hospital and/or rehab facilities, arranging meals for those recuperating at home, arranging rides to Meeting and whatever else that arises. In addition, the committee assists families requesting memorial services under the care of the Meeting, forms clearness committees for marriage under the care of the Meeting as well as forms clearness committees for personal discernment and support committees as requested. Members also represent Care & Counsel on clearness committees for those seeking membership.

The Care & Counsel Committee continued to lead Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the second and fourth Wednesdays. Due to the health challenges of several Friends involved in sending the invitation on Tuesdays and compiling the list on Wednesdays, leadership has evolved temporarily into the hands of the committee clerk. Judging by the long list of names submitted each month, this practice is well appreciated by those in our community.

In February, we presented a Forum on "Preparation for Incapacity and Death." Our meeting website (chapelhillfriends.org) has resources that we wanted Friends to be aware of to help in making plans for care during our inevitable decline and demise.

We lost four cherished Friends this year. Will Wyland died December 10, 2024. A Memorial Service to celebrate his life was held under the care of the Meeting at Chapel Hill Friends Meeting on January 12, 2025, ably clerked by Tom Munk.

We tended to Joyce and Lamb Sandy after her tragic accident February 28, 2025, when she was injured by a fire hose that came loose from a passing fire truck. This involved supporting their daughter Simone, especially in care of Lamb during times she had to return home to her family in Philadelphia. In Simone's absence, we provided Lamb meals and supervised his medication at the needed times for several days. Sadly, Joyce died May 29, 2025. We guided Simone in leading a Quaker-style Memorial Service at the Seymour Senior Center on July 12, 2025. A large group came to celebrate Joyce's life.

Barbara Williamson died at Carol Woods on September 24, 2025. Alice worked with her daughter, Amy Fitchet, and Miriam Tohill, Carol Woods Spiritual Care Coordinator, for the memorial service that was held on November 14, 2025, at Carol Woods. As Barbara grew up Episcopalian, her daughter requested the service be half Episcopal and half Quaker. Miriam led the Episcopal part while Alice led the Quaker part.

In addition, we supported Maggie Flash when she traveled from Japan to be with her mother, Bettie Flash, during her last days. Bettie died June 2, 2025. Maggie stayed with Alice Carlton and her husband Dave Curtin for four months while Maggie tended to the many tasks required before and after her mother's death. A Memorial Service for Bettie will be held under the care of

the Meeting in July 2026 at the Carol Woods Retirement Community. At Maggie and her brother Will's request, Alice will lead the celebration of Bettie's long life.

Tom Munk took on the huge task of organizing geographically located small groups to aid Friends in getting to know each other on a deeper level and for support in the aftermath of the election. Kate Fitch of the Adult Religious Education Committee was a big help in this process. The groups began to meet in March. Friends participated in these groups with enthusiasm. Some fulfilled the initial commitment of four monthly meetings and were laid down. Many groups continue to meet.

At each monthly meeting, Care & Counsel Committee considers a long list of individuals who need our care, often ten or more. In addition, we have several clearness and support committees to hear from. Some meet for a short time, some meet off and on and some are ongoing. We strictly adhere to the rules of confidentiality and do our best to respond promptly when someone reaches out for our care.

This year we had the joy of welcoming two babies, James and Robin Harper's daughter Emily's child, Danielle, and Daniel Hill's new baby, Oberon, and the joy of forming a clearness committee for marriage for Rita Kuwahara and Haralamb Braileanu on which Bonnie Raphael, Carolyn Stuart and Alice Carlton served. Gwynne Pomeroy with Friends Julia Cleaver, Matt Drake, John Pilgrim, and Monteze Snyder also served on the membership clearness committees of Tony Hickey. Tom Munk with Friends Jennifer Leeman, Matt and Lynn Drake, and Carolyn White served on Mark and Tori Toles membership clearness committee.

We also joined Tori Toles and Friends from Hospitality Committee in organizing a "FriendsGiving" meal for Thanksgiving. We feasted in the multi-purpose room with twenty-one people, enjoying the lovely decorations created by several Friends in attendance.

Two committee members, Tom Munk and Carolyn Stuart, represented Care & Counsel Committee by serving on the search Committee for the new Meeting Clerk. In 2025, we bid a fond farewell to Carolyn Stuart who rotated off C&C. We welcomed Jeff Brown as our new Meeting Clerk which changed his status on C&C from member to ex-officio member. We also welcomed Emilie Condon as our newest member. We now have one opening for a new member.

Respectfully submitted,

Alice Carlton (clerk), Emilie Condon, Richard Miller, Tom Munk, Gwynne Pomeroy, Bonnie Raphael, Leslie Rountree and Jeff Brown, ex-officio.

Appendix C: Shotts Memorial and Leadership Development Fund, 2024-2025

The Mary and Claude Shotts/Leadership Development Funds Committee oversees two funds to support the leadings of Friends, both members and attenders, to enrich and deepen their capacity for leadership within the Meeting, the local community, and the Religious Society of Friends.

Financial support is NOT need-based but is the Meeting's opportunity to support the spiritual and leadership development of our Meeting family.

The Mary and Claude Shotts Memorial Fund provides financial support to enrich and develop the lives of individuals with a relationship to the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting. The Leadership Development Fund provides grants to benefit the spiritual life of the Meeting through the enhancement of leadership capabilities in individuals. It should be noted that these funds are available to standing committees in the Meeting to support honoraria awarded to outside speakers who may be here for special events and programs open to the Meeting community.

Friends Fiduciary manages the investments for the Shotts Memorial Fund, and the current principal balance is $44,220.64 which is considerably higher than last year's figure. Our committee receives interest disbursements from the Shotts Memorial Fund twice a year, in June and December. Those disbursements are usually in the range of $700 each time.

Grants from the Leadership Development Fund are given from money carried over from prior years and, if requested, from annual allocations approved by the Meeting for Worship with attention to business. Considering overall CHFM budgetary concerns, our committee chose not to request funds for 2025-2026.

The past fiscal year grants included:

$350 - Meeting teen to attend SAYF retreat, May 2025
$151 - PFYM May retreat

Three or four times a year information about our committee is posted in the e-news. Unfortunately, that form of PR has not been terribly successful. We have now begun making post-worship announcements and are already seeing immediate results.

We encourage Friends to stay alert to opportunities, including those with fees charged, that may be of interest to you. Committees may also submit funding requests for activities, such as retreats, etc. If you have questions about applicability, our committee more than welcomes your email queries. We're here to support your growth as Quakers and leaders.

Jan Hutton, Clerk, on behalf of members Roberto Quercia, Madelyn Ashley, and Jessica Harper

Appendix D: Proposal for Ad hoc Committee Concerning Zoom Operations

The Zoom subcommittee, under the care of the Ministry & Worship Committee, has been operating Zoom for online Meetings for Worship since 2020 and twice-a-month blended Meetings for Worship and occasionally blended Forums since 2022. Tasks and attention by a Zoom technical host take between 2.5 to 3.5 hours each First Day.

Zoom technical hosts have been happy to enable remote participation, yet clearly it is difficult for a technical host to fully participate in worship and adult religious education. The Meeting has recognized this drawback to the steadfast technical support by a few Friends, especially by Quaker Harmon. At least two years ago, the Meeting created a line item in the annual budget for the expense of hiring a Zoom operator for weekly service.

Friends have met technical needs without hiring technical help to date. ARE has increasingly hosted forums, and online Closers from Ministry and Worship now tech host online worship. However, meeting the technical needs of blended Worship and blended Forums is increasingly falling on fewer available volunteers. Whether or not the Meeting decides to hold more frequent blended meetings or forums, the Ministry & Worship Committee senses that the time has come to hire a Zoom operator for weekly service. Last month, the committee asked the Meeting Clerk to bring a proposal to Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business.

On behalf of the Ministry & Worship Committee and the Zoom subcommittee, I propose that we form an ad hoc committee to clarify the details of a job description, terms of engagement, costs, and a process for hiring someone to serve the Meeting. The ad hoc committee would report to Ministry & Worship for seasoning before a recommendation to Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business.

Jeff Brown, Clerk